

Friday, 19 June 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON

Partly cloudy

30° 18°

BIRMINGHAM

Overcast

25° 16°

MANCHESTER

Drizzle

24° 18°

GLASGOW

Rain

17° 15°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- 1 A body has been discovered in the landing gear of a plane at Gatwick Airport, prompting an investigation.**
Emergency services were called after airport staff found the body on an Air Arabia craft. Details are still emerging about the individual and how they came to be there.

CRIME · UK

- 2 Amber heat health alerts have been issued across parts of the UK, with temperatures expected to soar above 30 degrees Celsius.**

This comes as Europe experiences a 'heat dome', bringing very warm conditions. Public health advice is being shared to help people stay safe in the heat.

WEATHER · UK

- 3 The jury in Sir Jeffrey Donaldson's sex abuse trial will continue its deliberations today (Friday).**
The former Democratic Unionist Party leader is on trial facing 18 charges, including one count of rape. He denies all allegations against him.

JUSTICE · UK

- 4 Two teenagers are currently on trial, accused of the murder of 15-year-old Amen Teklay in Glasgow.**
Prosecutors allege the boys chased and attacked him with a sword, causing fatal injuries. The incident left the community in shock.

CRIME · UK

- 5 Voters are heading to the polls today in Greater Manchester for the Makerfield by-election.**
Fourteen candidates are vying to become the constituency's new Member of Parliament. It's a key moment for local politics.

POLITICS · UK

What's coming up

- 1 **The fifth instalment of the beloved 'Toy Story' franchise is dividing critics, but many are praising its 'cautionary' message about technology.**
Tom Hanks, Tim Allen, and Joan Cusack all return to voice their iconic characters. It's a chance to see how Woody and Buzz navigate a new era.
ON AIR – Are you excited for another Toy Story? Do you think it's time to let the franchise rest, or are you happy for more?
FILM · COMING SOON

- 2 **The new London Museum site in Smithfield is set to open its doors to the public this November.**
It will become the new home for some fascinating exhibits, including Banksy's piranhas and the UK's oldest hand-written document. A fantastic new cultural attraction for the capital.
ON AIR – What's the one museum exhibit you'd travel to see? Is there a particular piece of history you find most captivating?
CULTURE · THIS YEAR

- 3 **Singer-songwriter Myles Smith has turned five years of therapy notes into his deeply personal debut album.**
His first collection is inspired by the experiences that shaped him before he found fame. It promises to be a very honest and reflective release.
ON AIR – What's an album that really helped you through a tough time? Or one that you feel tells a truly personal story?
MUSIC · NEW RELEASE

- 4 **Harry Styles is kicking off his Wembley residency, and reminiscing about his X Factor audition that took place nearby back in 2010.**
The pop superstar is back on a familiar stage, reflecting on the start of his incredible journey. Fans are eagerly awaiting his performances.
ON AIR – What's your favourite Harry Styles song to sing along to? Or a memory you have of seeing him perform?
MUSIC · THIS WEEK

- 5 **The head of MI5, Sir Ken McCallum, has revealed himself to be a big fan of the popular spy series 'Slow Horses'.**
The show, often described as the 'anti-James Bond', clearly has a high-profile admirer. Perhaps he's taking notes!
ON AIR – Are you a fan of 'Slow Horses'? What's your favourite spy show or film that doesn't take itself too seriously?
TV · ONGOING

On the schedule

1 **England opener Emilio Gay hit a patient 53 against New Zealand at The Oval, but then gave his wicket away in bizarre circumstances.**

After reaching his milestone, Gay was caught on the very next ball, leaving England 142-3 in their first innings. It was a moment of milestone followed by misery.

ON AIR – Have you ever seen a sporting moment where a player went from hero to zero in an instant? What's the most unusual dismissal you've witnessed?

CRICKET · UK

2 **New Zealand's Glenn Phillips scored his first Test century against England, helping his side to a strong total on day two at The Oval.**

Phillips' impressive knock guided New Zealand to 391 in their first innings. It's a significant milestone in his career.

ON AIR – How important is a maiden Test century for a player's confidence? What's your favourite memory of a player reaching a century?

CRICKET · UK

3 **Scandinavia has won the Gold Cup at Royal Ascot, bringing up trainer Aidan O'Brien's incredible 100th winner at the festival.**

It was a momentous victory, beating Trawlerman in a thrilling race. O'Brien's achievement further cements his legendary status in racing.

ON AIR – Have you ever been to Royal Ascot, or another major racing event? What's the most exciting race you've ever watched?

HORSE RACING · UK

4 **The Lionesses will face Greece in the first round of the 2027 Women's World Cup play-offs.**

Northern Ireland, Scotland, and Wales have also learned their opponents for the crucial qualifiers. The road to the World Cup is now clearer for the home nations.

ON AIR – Who are you backing to make it through the play-offs? What's your favourite memory of the Lionesses in a major tournament?

FOOTBALL · UK

5 **Jacob Bethell took two late wickets for England, leaving the second Test against New Zealand delicately poised after day one.**

The tourists closed on 291-7, with England fighting back to keep the match balanced. It sets up an exciting day two at The Oval.

ON AIR – What's your favourite part of Test cricket – the tactical battles, the individual brilliance, or the ebb and flow of the game?

CRICKET · UK

Quick hits

- 1 A new trend is seeing people create 'analogue photo albums' to cherish physical memories.**
In an age of digital overload, more individuals are taking the time to print their favourite photos and arrange them in beautifully curated, tangible albums. It's a lovely way to disconnect and revisit precious moments.
- 2 Research highlights the calming benefits of 'slow walking' in natural environments.**
Taking unhurried strolls, particularly through parks or woodlands, has been shown to reduce stress and improve mental clarity. It's all about mindfully enjoying the journey, rather than rushing to a destination.
- 3 The popularity of 'vintage stationery' is on the rise, sparking a return to letter writing.**
From fountain pens to wax seals, people are rediscovering the joy of putting pen to paper with elegant, old-fashioned supplies. There's something truly special about receiving a handwritten note, isn't there?
- 4 Experts note a growing interest in 'urban foraging' for wild edibles in city green spaces.**
With proper knowledge and caution, city dwellers are learning to identify and sustainably harvest edible plants like wild garlic and elderflower from local parks and allotments. It connects them to nature in a surprising way.
- 5 A study suggests that incorporating 'storytelling' into daily routines can boost family bonding.**
Sharing tales, whether made-up or based on family history, before bedtime or during mealtimes, helps create stronger connections and encourages imagination. It's a timeless activity for all ages.
- 6 The trend for 'micro-gardening' in small spaces is helping city residents embrace green fingers.**
From windowsills to tiny balconies, people are cleverly growing herbs, vegetables, and flowers in compact containers. It proves you don't need a sprawling garden to enjoy the simple pleasure of cultivating plants.
- 7 New research shows that 'daydreaming' can actually improve problem-solving skills and creativity.**
Allowing your mind to wander and explore different scenarios, without immediate pressure, helps foster innovative ideas and solutions. So next time you're caught staring into space, tell them you're just being productive!

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 50% of us admit to secretly 'rehearsing' what in our heads before we say it out loud?

ANSWER: A POLITE REFUSAL, LIKE 'NO THANK YOU, I'M JUST LOOKING!'

Q A recent poll asked Brits what small, everyday 'task' instantly makes them feel satisfied and organised. What came out on top?

ANSWER: LINING UP ALL THE SPICES IN THE CUPBOARD ALPHABETICALLY.

TALK TOPIC

- You know how sometimes you hear a particular 'word' or 'phrase' that just instantly grates on you, even if it's perfectly innocent?

What's that one word or phrase that, for some reason, just makes you inwardly cringe or raises an eyebrow, even if you know it's a bit silly to feel that way?

- We all have those little 'superstitions' or 'rituals' we stick to, even if we don't truly believe in them, just in case!

What's a quirky little superstition or a specific 'good luck' ritual that you still find yourself doing, even if it's just for fun or out of habit?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Space.** There is a planet made almost entirely of diamond, named '55 Cancri e', twice the size of Earth.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** Astronauts on the International Space Station can see the Great Wall of China with the naked eye from orbit.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£6.46 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£6.46 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- A group of flamingos is called a 'flamboyance'.
- It is impossible to hum while holding your nose.
- The inventor of the Pringles can is buried in one.
- Butterflies taste with their feet.
- The longest place name in the UK is Llanfairpwllgwyngyllgogerychwyrndrobwlllantysiliogogogoch.
- Cows have best friends and get stressed when separated from them.
- The original name for the search engine Google was 'Backrub'.
- Chameleons change their skin colour not just to blend in, but also to reflect their mood and temperature.

On this day

Day 170 of the year, 195 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Deodatus (or Didier) of Nevers (or of Jointures); Christian feast day: Gervasius and Protasius (Catholic Church); Christian feast day: Hildegim of Châlons; Christian feast day: Juliana Falconieri. Star sign Gemini, birthstone Pearl.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1928 — Nancy Marchand, American actress (died 2000)
- 1975 — Hugh Dancy, English actor and model
- 1946 — Jimmy Greenhoff, English footballer and manager
- 1984 — Paul Dano, American actor
- 1992 — Keaton Jennings, South African-English cricketer
- 1978 — Zoe Saldaña, American actress
- 1970 — Brian Welch, American singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1965 — Sadie Frost, English actress and producer

THE DAY TODAY

- 1987 — Aeroflot Flight N-528 crashes at Berdiansk Airport in present-day Ukraine, killing eight people.
- 1945 — The Smoke Tragedy left 355 workers dead in the underground copper mine of El Teniente, Chile.
- 1964 — The Civil Rights Act of 1964 is approved after surviving an 83-day filibuster in the United States Senate.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1961 — Kuwait declares independence from the United Kingdom.
- 2012 — WikiLeaks founder Julian Assange requests asylum in London's Ecuadorian Embassy for fear of extradition to the US after publication of previously classified documents including footage of civilian killings by the US army; he will remain there until 2019.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1945 — The Smoke Tragedy left 355 workers dead in the underground copper mine of El Teniente, Chile.
- 1982 — The People's Armed Police is de facto founded; It is officially established 10 months later on April 5, 1983

- 1964 — The Civil Rights Act of 1964 is approved after surviving an 83-day filibuster in the United States Senate.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 171 of the year, 194 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Adalbert of Magdeburg; Christian feast day: Blessed Dermot O'Hurley; Christian feast day: Florentina; Christian feast day: John of Matera. Star sign Gemini, birthstone Pearl.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1966 — Boaz Yakin, American director, producer, and screenwriter
- 1947 — Dolores "LaLa" Brooks, American pop singer
- 1967 — Dan Tyminski, American singer-songwriter
- 1952 — John Goodman, American actor
- 1940 — John Mahoney, English-born American actor (died 2018)
- 1954 — Michael Anthony, American musician
- 1954 — Allan Lamb, South African-English cricketer and sportscaster
- 1978 — Quinton Jackson, American mixed martial artist and actor

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1956 — A Venezuelan Super-Constellation crashes in the Atlantic Ocean off Asbury Park, New Jersey, killing 74 people.
- 1948 — The Deutsche Mark is introduced in Western Allied-occupied Germany. The Soviet Military Administration in Germany responded by imposing the Berlin Blockade four days later.
- 1996 — Space Shuttle Columbia launches on STS-78 to conduct life science and microgravity research aboard the Spacelab module.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1979 — ABC News correspondent Bill Stewart is shot dead by a Nicaraguan National Guard soldier under the regime of Anastasio Somoza Debayle during the Nicaraguan Revolution. The murder is caught on tape and sparks an international outcry against the regime.
- 1994 — The 1994 Imam Reza shrine bomb explosion in Iran leaves at least 25 dead and 70 to 300 injured.

Coming to cinemas

JUNE 2026	
FRI 19	Pixar's Toy Story 5
FRI 26	Supergirl: Woman of Tomorrow (+ IMAX); A Private Life

JULY 2026	
WED 1	Minions & Monsters
FRI 3	Shiver; Young Washington
FRI 10	Moana (live action); Evil Dead Burn
FRI 17	Christopher Nolan's The Odyssey (+ IMAX); Cut Off
FRI 24	Heads of State; Untitled DCU
FRI 31	Spider-Man: Brand New Day

AUGUST 2026	
FRI 7	Once Upon a Time in a Cinema
FRI 14	Flowervale Street; PAW Patrol 3: The Dino Movie
FRI 21	Mutiny; The Bride!
FRI 28	Crime 101; Outcome

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites
FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

On the sporting calendar

JUNE 2026		JULY 2026	
11 JUN – 19 JUL	FIFA World Cup (USA / Canada / Mexico)	4–26 JUL	Tour de France (Cycling)
12 JUN – 5 JUL	ICC Women's T20 World Cup (England & Wales)	SUN 5	British Grand Prix, Silverstone
18–21 JUN	U.S. Open (Golf)	16–19 JUL	The Open Championship (Golf)
29 JUN – 12 JUL	Wimbledon	18–26 JUL	World Matchplay Darts, Blackpool
		23 JUL – 2 AUG	Commonwealth Games, Glasgow
		AUGUST 2026	
		W/C 10	Hundred & T20 Blast climax (Cricket)
		SAT 15	Premier League season begins (2026/27)
		22–23	Belgian Grand Prix (F1)